

BANDEEP SINGH



KAPILA VATSYAYAN
80, CULTURAL ADMINISTRATOR (NEW)

QUEEN OF ARTS

BECAUSE her power of patronage does not depend on her position. Because of all the big-ticket cultural events in 2006, Sonia Gandhi chose to inaugurate an exhibition curated by her in Belgium. Because her academic work continues to be authoritative, whether it is an exhibition on indigo as part of the India International Centre's Asia project or a book she has just edited on the shared traditions of Asia. Because although many seek her blessings to rise in the cultural firmament, she doesn't give them lightly. Because if Bhishmapitamah were a woman, she would be him in the cultural arena.

BIG SCREEN OUTING:
In the recently re-released Rajan Khosa film, *Dance of the Wind*, she plays Karuna Devi, the classical musician mother of Kitu Gidwani.

USUALLY TO BE FOUND: As chief guest at the Sahitya Akademi Awards or at IIC, where she is on the board of trustees.

SHE IS THE ONLY INDIAN ON UNESCO'S EXECUTIVE BOARD.



A.R. RAHMAN
42, MUSIC DIRECTOR (37)

GLOBAL PLAYER

BECAUSE his music belongs to the world. Because the West sees in him the musical successor to Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan. Because his soundtracks for movies can pop up in the unlikelyst of spots, from the opening credits of the Hollywood film, *Inside Man*, to the title sequence of a Palestinian film, *Divine Intervention*. Because in a world where quantity drowns quality, his music is not a mere tune but often a mystical experience. Because he works only with those who understand this.

SMART GUY MOVE:
Starting the K.M. Music Conservatory in Chennai for Indian and Western musicians.

RECENT ACQUISITION:
The \$3.470 (Rs 1,40,000) continuum keyboard.

COOL NEW BUDDIES:
"Some dudes from Atlanta."

THORN IN HIS SIDE:
Deadlines. He usually works at night, after his prayers are done, often collaborating with others on Skype and e-mail.